

	EMERGENCY MEDICAL SERVICES AGENCY	POLICY NUMBER	744
	A Division of the Merced County Department of Public Health	Effective Date	11/2025
Authority: Health and Safety Code, Division 2.5, and California Code of Regulations, Title 22, Division 9, Chapter 4, 1797.220		Initial Date:	10/2011
		Review Date:	04/2028

ENVENOMATION / BITES / STINGS

May present as a localized reaction with redness, pain and swelling at the site or a systemic reaction such as itchiness, flushing of skin, rash, urticaria, tachycardia, and anaphylaxis.

For Allergic Reaction / Anaphylaxis - **Refer to EMS Policy #726 – Allergic Reaction.**

ADULT

PEDIATRIC

BLS

Assess Vitals / Obtain SpO₂ / Oxygen - Titrate to SpO₂ of 94% or higher / Secure Airway - Assist Ventilations if needed.

Nothing by Mouth - Do not give patients anything to eat or drink.

Identify Wound

- Note location of the wound and identify extent of redness or swelling
- Mark affected area and track swelling every fifteen (15) minutes

Immobilize / Circulation - Immobilize the affected extremity.

Remove distal jewelry.

Assess circulation, sensation, and motor function before and after immobilization every fifteen (15) minutes.

ALS

Follow BLS procedures if applicable.

Obtain 4-Lead ECG – If indicated.

Vascular Access – If indicated.

Pain Management - Treat pain as appropriate.

Insect Bites and Stings

Assess wound(s) and remove stinger by scraping with an edge of a stiff object, such as a credit card.

May use localized ice pack for pain and swelling. Do not apply ice directly to the skin.

Black Widow Spider Bites

Localized signs and symptoms include immediate pain, redness, and swelling at the site.

Systemic signs and symptoms may include progressive muscle spasms, severe abdominal pain, nausea and vomiting, sweating, seizures, paralysis, hypertension, and/or diminished level of consciousness.

Signatures on File

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If Muscle Spasms Are Severe

Midazolam – 2 mg IV/IO OR 5 mg IN/IM

- Titrate IV/IO in **1 mg** increments to control muscle spasms, max dose 5 mg
- May repeat IN/IM once after 10 minutes if spasms continue

Midazolam - 0.1 mg/kg IV/IO/IM/IN

- Max dose 1 mg
- May repeat once after 10 minutes if spasms continue

Snakebites

Do not transport a live snake, even if you think it is dead, do not touch. Take pictures of snake, if possible.
Do not apply ice.

Do not incise or attempt to suck the venom from the wound.

Do not apply constricting band or tourniquet. If constricting band or tourniquet has been applied, prior to arrival, do not release.

Pain, edema, and discoloration may be present.

Systemic signs and symptoms may be present and could include:

- Nausea/Vomiting, weakness, diaphoresis, chills, and/or dizziness
- Change in taste may be reported as a minty, rubbery, or metallic taste
- Tingling, numbness, and fasciculations (spasms) of face